

» FROM THE
WORLD OF FOOTBALL

FIGHT AND FLAIR

Estevao Willian's **late heroics** helped Chelsea topple Liverpool, while Kylian Mbappe registered a Champions League hat-trick.

Aneesh Dey and Joan Mathew Jacob

aneesh.dey@thehindu.co.in, joan.mathew@thehindu.co.in



FOR MORE
STORIES

The World Champions vs the Champion of England — that was the showpiece fixture in the latest matchday of the Premier League. Both Chelsea and Liverpool entered the fixture after losing their last league games, against Brighton and Hove Albion and Crystal Palace, respectively. It was a hard one to call and had all the ingredients of a brilliant contest.

At home, Chelsea had slightly more reason to believe, and in the end, Stamford Bridge rejoiced. The Blues edged a 2-1 win against the Reds, and the fact that it was 18-year-old Estevao Willian who scored a 90+5-minute winner made the occasion all the more special for Chelsea and its faithful.

Moises Caicedo had already brought down the roof at Stamford Bridge with a screamer

from outside the box when he opened the scoring in the 14th minute. With Chelsea dominating the overall stats, it looked like the Blues would get a narrow win at home, but Cody Gakpo levelled the scores with an opportunistic strike set up by Alexander Isak.

With scores level at the 90th minute, all signs pointed towards a draw, but in the fifth minute of added time, Marc Cucurella made a darting run down the left flank and squared the ball to Estevao at the far post. The cross took Liverpool goalkeeper Giorgi Mamardashvili out of the equation, and the Brazilian slid in to slot the ball home to clinch three points for his team.

Another big piece of news out of English top-flight football was Crystal Palace's 19-game unbeaten run coming to an end after it lost 1-2 against Everton. With the score level at the 90th-minute mark, it seemed like Oliver Glasner's men would keep their unbeaten run